

Everyone Else • 11/39 • Qambar

The **Better Shirt**. Qambar served Imam Ali. Five items, no event print, dateless.

One style for the whole line — Fraunces and Nunito Sans, cut paper, the person on a stamp. Still open where it shows: the fact panel is TO VERIFY and the return address is not set.

ENVELOPE — C5, 229 × 162 MM

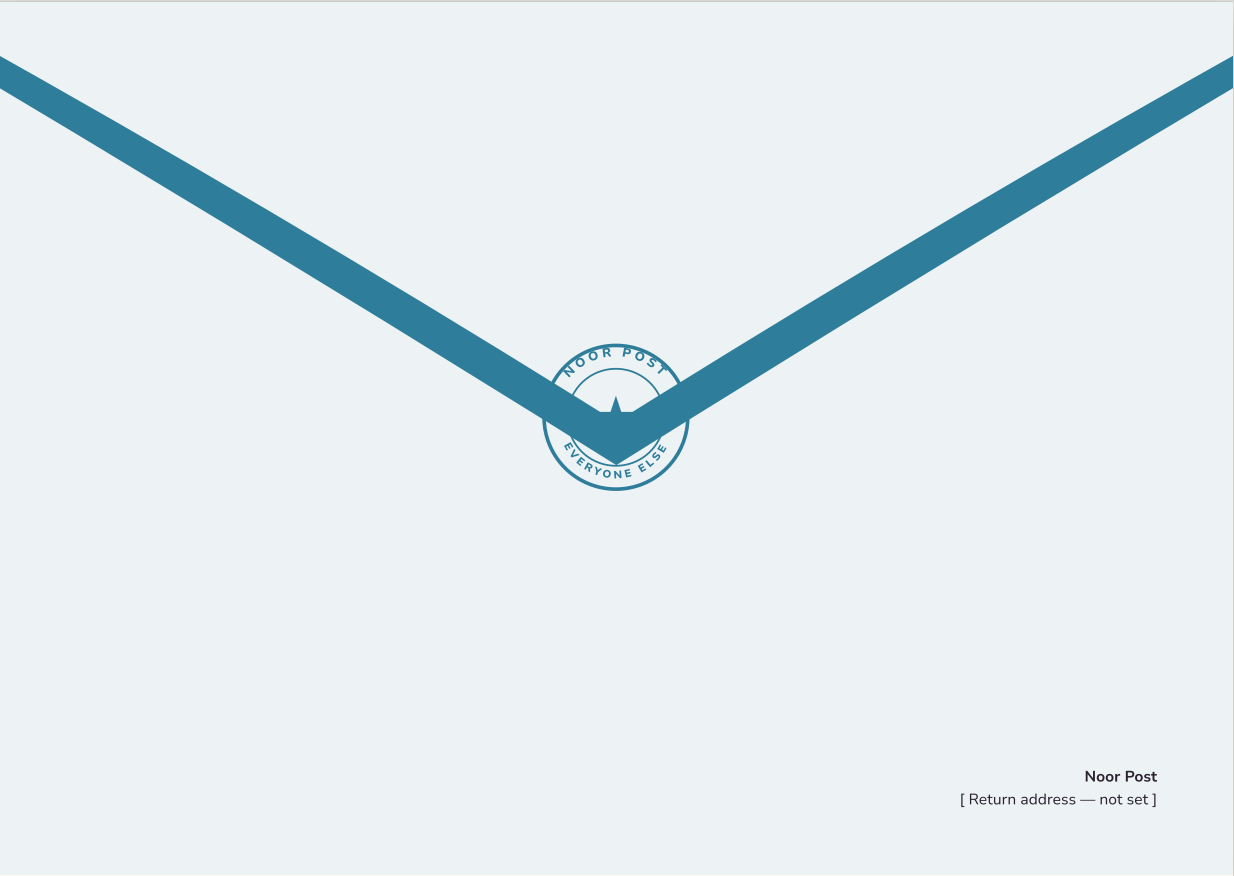
NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

**Qambar served Imam
Ali.**

FOR

[Child's name]





INSIDE THE FLAP

EVERYONE ELSE ·
QAMBAR · INSIDE THE
FLAP

Open together.

● is the grown-up. ○ is you.

- 1 The letter — read it out loud, ● and ○ taking turns
- 2 The hadith card
- 3 The print
- 4 The stickers
- 5 The postcard

Qambar

- **Who he was.** A member of Imam Ali's household in Kufa. He had been enslaved, and was bought and freed by him, and stayed on afterwards in his service.
- **How he appears in the record.** Constantly, and in small ways — carrying messages, at the door, sent to bring somebody. **He is one of the very few people in these accounts we see doing ordinary daily work.**
- **The shirts.** The account of the two shirts is reported with the reason given: that the younger man would take more pleasure in the better one.
- **What it tells you.** The household of a man running an empire had almost nothing in it. The reports agree on this from several directions — plain food, plain clothes, a house you would not pick out.
- **Afterwards.** He remained loyal to Imam Ali's memory under a government that punished exactly that, and the accounts say it cost him his life under al-Hajjaj.
- **Why he is in this envelope.** *Qambar served Imam Ali.*

He was killed at Kufa, on the orders of al-Hajjaj ibn Yusuf.

The Better Shirt



• is the grown-up • ◯ is you • ●◯ is together

- Two men went to a market in Kufa to buy clothes. One of them was running an empire that stretched from Egypt to the edge of India. The other one worked for him, in his house, and had been bought and freed by him years before.

◯ Which one had the money?

- Both, that day. They were buying two shirts, one each, and the shirts were not the same. One was a bit better. Slightly nicer cloth, a bit more money.

◯ Who got it?

- Have a guess first. Actually — don't guess. Just say what you think should happen and see whether you were right.

◯ The one in charge?

- Qambar got the better one. The man running the empire took the cheaper shirt and wore it, and there is a reason recorded for it, and the reason is not that he was being humble at anybody.

◯ What was it?

THE BETTER SHIRT · CONTINUED

- That Qambar was younger. Young men like nice clothes and it matters to them more, and he said so, and that was the end of it.

◦ **That's the whole reason?**

- That is the whole reason. Not a lesson, not a demonstration, not something done in front of an audience to make a point. Two men bought two shirts and the younger one got the better shirt because he would enjoy it more.

◦ **Would you have taken it? Say yes or no honestly.**

- Now think about who this man was. He appointed the judges. He commanded the army. Every governor in that empire held their job at his word. And in a market in his own capital he is haggling over which of two shirts he takes home, and losing.

- Qambar stayed with him for the rest of his life. He is in the accounts in the ordinary way — carrying things, answering the door, being sent to fetch someone. He is not there because he did something enormous once. He is there because he was there every day.

SAY THIS ONE TOGETHER

•◦

**He got the better shirt.
That is the story.**



Then the hadith card.

FIRST EDITION · 11/39

IMAM ALI SAID

**“Do you not know that
walking with the rider ruins
the manners of the rider and
humiliate the walker? Leave
me now.”**

Imam Ali

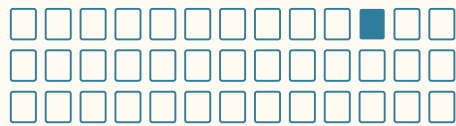


NOT A SILSILA SEGMENT · THIS SET HAS ITS OWN CHAIN

NOOR POST · EVERYONE ELSE

The other chain

The box holds fourteen cards, one for each of the Fourteen.
This set is the people around them: thirty-nine cards, collected
in any order.



First edition · thirty-nine cards

IN OUR WORDS

**When one person rides and another
walks behind, it is bad for both of them.**

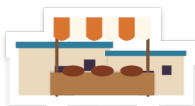
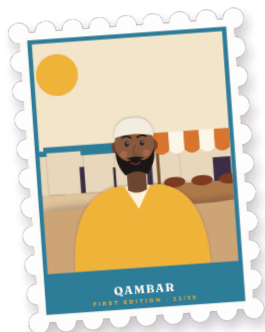
Noor Post's own words, not the translation.

Tuhaf al-Uqul, short maxims of Imam Ali, no. 62. Translated by Badr
Shahin, Ansariyan Publications, Qum.

Back — its own chain, no silsila number



Qambar





**We opened this one
together.**

- _____
- _____

Post it back to us, or keep it. Either is right.

STAMP

Noor Post

[Return address — not set]
